

ICS 406 - IT Project Management

Module 1 – INTRODUCTION & OVERVIEW OF PROJECT MANAGEMENT

The Course Outline

ICS 406 IT Project-management

2 Credits

Issues in IT Project-Management. Project quality assurance, project risk management, project cost estimation, project risk management, project time management, project human resource management, system reliability, system testing etc.

15h (T); 45h (P); C

Projects

Projects have:

- A set of tasks with a clear deliverable and a deadline for completion
- Relates to creating, updating, or reviewing a particular document, process, outcome, or another single unit of work
- A predefined scope that is limited to a specific output
- Improves quality, efficiency, cost management, or customer satisfaction in a specific and predetermined way

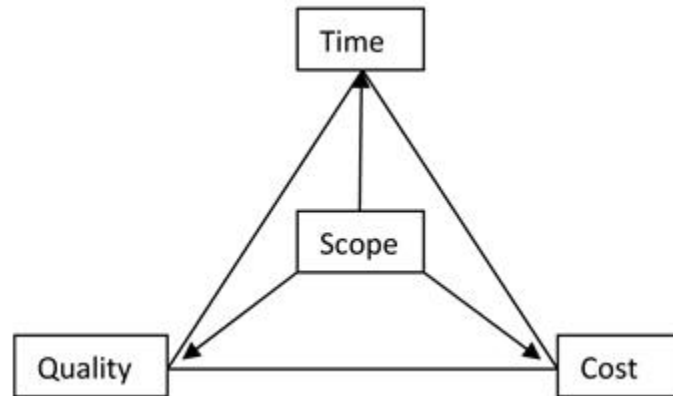
Projects have the following two key features:

Transience

A project has a specific start and end point and is set up to meet specific [objectives](#), to create a specified result, product or service.

Scope - time, cost and quality

Projects need to be controlled to meet their objectives and deliver benefits. Objectives are defined in terms of expectations of time, cost and quality.



Time, cost and quality are called objectives or constraints. For example:

- The project must be completed by January 2013 (time).
- The project must not spend more than £500,000 (cost).
- The project should create a searchable and informative website (quality).

All the work that has to be done to achieve the time, cost and quality objectives defines the project scope. The scope can change over time, and it is the project manager's responsibility to ensure the project will still deliver its defined benefits. A project manager must maintain focus on the relative priorities of time, cost and quality.

What is project management?

The Association for Project Management (APM) defines project management as the application of processes, methods, skills, knowledge and experience to achieve specific project objectives according to the project **acceptance criteria** within agreed parameters.

A key factor that distinguishes project management from just 'management' is that it has a **final deliverable** and a **finite timespan**, unlike management which is an ongoing process. Because of this, a project professional needs a wide range of skills; often technical skills, certainly people management skills, and good business awareness.

What does a Project Manager do?

1. Plans projects
2. Tracks progress of projects
3. Allocates resources
4. Manages risks
5. Communicates

This involves:

1. Understanding the needs of stakeholders.
2. Planning what needs to be done, when, by whom, and to what standards.
3. Building and motivating the team.
4. Coordinating the work of different people.
5. Monitoring work being done.
6. Managing any changes to the plan.
7. Delivering successful results.

A typical day for a project manager can include:

- Checking on the status of a deliverable to determine whether it will be delivered on time and within budget
- Reviewing a queue to identify new work, monitor existing tasks, and unblock specific elements for the project team
- Create a plan for how to reach a specific milestone that describes the stakeholder management and communications opportunities
- Ensure that project work meets the quality and reliability requirements established at the beginning of the project

Note:

Project management focuses on controlling the introduction of the desired change.

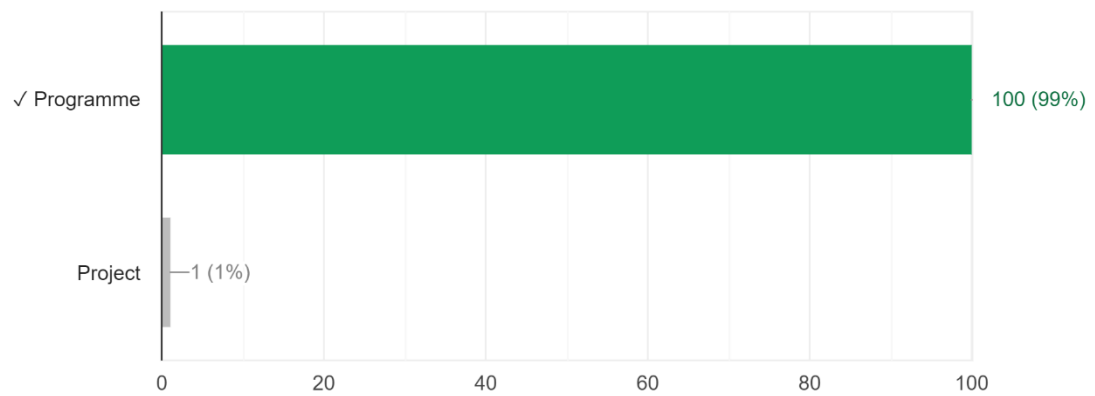
ICS 406 Opening Quiz

101 responses

[Publish analytics](#)

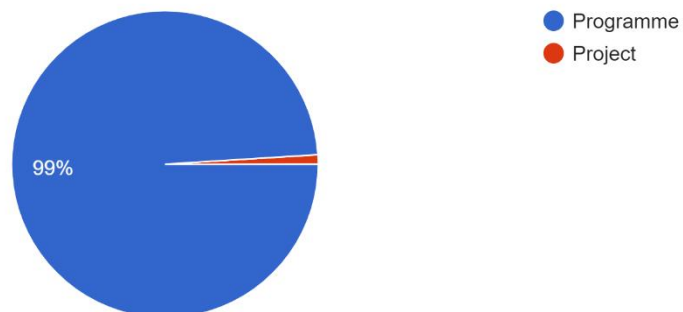
Is your B.Sc. in Information and Communication Science a Project or a Programme?

100 / 101 correct responses



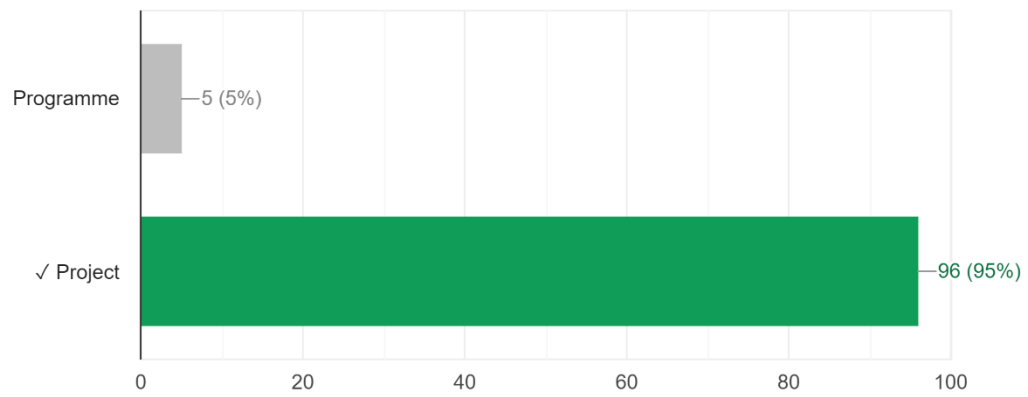
Is your B.Sc. in Information and Communication Science a Project or a Programme?

101 responses



Is the course ICS 499 a a Project or a Programme?

96 / 101 correct responses



Is the course ICS 499 a a Project or a Programme?

101 responses

